Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 7 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Light drizzle	Drizzle	Light drizzle
11° 8°	11° 7°	11° 9°	11° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Met Police boss 'wouldn't be surprised' if more allegations made about Brand.**
Sir Mark Rowley tells the BBC that what he heard reported from Brand's trial came close to "victim blaming".
UK · NEWS

2 **Brand's barrister refers himself to regulator after report he confronted journalist.**
Ian Winter allegedly confronted a reporter outside court who had investigated the comedian.
UK · NEWS

3 **'Misleading' student loans information left out examples of higher-salary repayments.**
The Treasury Committee chair says she is "shocked" after one university compared repayments to the price of coffee.
UK · NEWS

4 **Tube drivers to stage strikes in Christmas run-up.**
The union is in dispute with London Underground over working arrangements for drivers.
UK · NEWS

5 **Manhunt after boy injured by sword, sparking Gloucester school lockdowns.**
Two schools went into lockdown following the incident and one woman has been arrested.
UK · NEWS

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Katherine Ryan says she feels 'grief and relief' after Russell Brand conviction.**
The comedian had previously spoken about an unnamed "predator" in the entertainment industry.
SHOWBIZ · UK

2 **Brand's barrister refers himself to regulator after report he confronted journalist.**
Ian Winter allegedly confronted a reporter outside court who had investigated the comedian.
SHOWBIZ · UK

3 **How 2000s lad culture helped Russell Brand to hide in plain sight.**
The behaviour that formed the backdrop to Brand's prosecution also helped elevate him, writes the BBC's media editor Katie Razzall.
SHOWBIZ · UK

4 **Met Police boss 'wouldn't be surprised' if more allegations made about Brand.**
Sir Mark Rowley tells the BBC that what he heard reported from Brand's trial came close to "victim blaming".
SHOWBIZ · UK

5 **'We had no idea how ill she was': Bono on recording Dolly Parton's last song.**
The rock group discuss Parton's final recording before her death, and why they refuse to be censored on stage.
SHOWBIZ · UK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Is Palmer's England career over under Tuchel?.**
Cole Palmer faces a fight to save his England career after he was excluded from Thomas Tuchel's latest squad, says chief football writer Phil McNulty.
SPORT · UK

2 **'A beautiful story' as Bellingham brothers called up.**
It may be a surprise to some but Jobe Bellingham's call up to the England senior side has been a long time coming.
SPORT · UK

3 **Player-coach rift report will only galvanise England - George.**
England hooker Jamie George says the squad are "really upset" by a newspaper article claiming the end of their summer tour was marked by player unrest over Steve Borthwick's leadership.
SPORT · UK

4 **Has Anderson lived up to the hype after Man City move?.**
As Elliot Anderson returns to Nottingham Forest after his £116m move to Manchester City, has he lived up to the price tag?
SPORT · UK

5 **Scotland come full circle for another crack at All Blacks.**
Sione Tuipulotu and Scotland have the chance to end one of sport's longest-standing hoodoos against New Zealand on Saturday, writes Andy Burke.
SPORT · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Brits are apparently buying more houseplants than ever — and naming them.**
A garden survey found nearly a third of plant owners have given their plants names, and a surprising number apologise to them when they forget to water.

2 **More households are growing herbs on the windowsill to cut grocery bills.**
Basil and mint are the favourites. Survival rates, gardeners admit, are 'mixed' — the basil rarely makes it past a fortnight.

3 **Jigsaw puzzles are still selling in huge numbers, years after their lockdown boom.**
1,000-piece designs are the sweet spot. The most dreaded puzzle remains anything that's mostly sky.

4 **The humble flask is having a comeback, with sales up sharply as people try to cut café spending.**
Retailers say the big winner is the 'keeps drinks hot for 12 hours' bottle — though most of us still drink it within the first one.

5 **The most-Googled DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.

6 **The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.

7 **More of us are taking up 'fake commutes' — a short walk before and after working from home.**
Psychologists say the made-up journey helps separate work from home life. Some people even pop to a shop and back to 'arrive'.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **60% of us have a 'good' version of THIS we save for visitors.**

ANSWER: THE NICE TOWELS NOBODY'S ALLOWED TO ACTUALLY USE.

Q **Asked the most annoying noise in everyday life, the top answer was THIS.**

ANSWER: SOMEONE ELSE'S PHONE ON FULL VOLUME ON THE TRAIN.

TALK TOPIC

- **New research says we're at our most creative in the shower.**
  What's the best idea you've ever had standing under the water — and did you actually do anything with it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire. Teaching at Oxford dates back to the 11th century, while the city of Tenochtitlan was founded in 1325.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Records have revealed that a Victorian town council once employed a man whose entire job was to walk the streets and tut at people dropping litter.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for 400 million years; trees only 350 million.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented as wallpaper. It flopped, so they pivoted to packaging.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on every beach on Earth.
- A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896 — it lasted 38 minutes.
- Your stomach gets a new lining every three to four days. Otherwise it would digest itself.
- The first message ever sent on the internet was 'LO' — they were trying to type 'LOGIN' but the system crashed.
- An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 7 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 311 of the year, 54 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Dominican Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Bartholomäus Ziegenbalg (Lutheran); Christian feast day: Engelbert II of Berg; Christian feast day: Herculanus of Perugia. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Lucas Neff, American actor
- 1938 — Dee Clark, American singer-songwriter (died 1990)
- 1938 — Barry Newman, American actor (died 2023)
- 1964 — Troy Beyer, American actress, director, and screenwriter
- 1978 — Barry Robson, Scottish footballer
- 1983 — Forrest Kline, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1967 — Steve Di Giorgio, American bass player
- 2001 — Amybeth McNulty, Irish actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1987 — In Tunisia, president Habib Bourguiba is overthrown and replaced by Prime Minister Zine El Abidine Ben Ali.
- 2020 — Joe Biden is confirmed elected as the 46th president of the United States, defeating incumbent Donald Trump.
- 1990 — Mary Robinson becomes the first woman to be elected President of the Republic of Ireland.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1786 — The oldest musical organization in the United States is founded as the Stoughton Musical Society.
- 1973 — The United States Congress overrides President Richard Nixon's veto of the War Powers Resolution, which limits presidential power to wage war without congressional approval.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1967 — Carl B. Stokes is elected as Mayor of Cleveland, Ohio, becoming the first African American mayor of a major American city.
- 2007 — The Jokela school shooting in Jokela, Tuusula, Finland, takes place, resulting in the death of nine people.

- 1972 — United States presidential election: U.S. President Richard Nixon is re-elected in the largest landslide victory at the time.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 8 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 312 of the year, 53 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Elisabetta Maria Satellico; Christian feast day: Four Crowned Martyrs; Christian feast day: Godfrey of Amiens; Christian feast day: Johann von Staupitz (Lutheran). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1991 — Riker Lynch, American actor and singer
- 1972 — Gretchen Mol, American model and actress
- 1939 — Meg Wynn Owen, British actress (died 2022)
- 1984 — Steven Webb, English actor
- 1943 — Martin Peters, English footballer and manager (died 2019)
- 1983 — Nikola Rachelle, English-New Zealand singer-songwriter and producer
- 1944 — Bonnie Bramlett, American singer and actress
- 1963 — Paul McKenna, English hypnotist and author

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1968 — The Vienna Convention on Road Traffic is signed to facilitate international road traffic and to increase road safety by standardising the uniform traffic rules among the signatories.
- 1966 — U.S. President Lyndon B. Johnson signs into law an antitrust exemption allowing the National Football League to merge with the upstart American Football League.
- 1983 — TAAG Angola Airlines Flight 462 crashes after takeoff from Lubango Airport killing all 130 people on board. UNITA claims to have shot down the aircraft, though this is disputed.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1972 — American pay television network Home Box Office (HBO) launches.
- 1994 — Republican Revolution: On the night of the 1994 United States midterm elections, Republicans make historic electoral gains by securing massive majorities in both houses of Congress (54 seats in the House and eight seats in the Senate, additionally), thus bringing to a close fo...

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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